

Kanban: Continuous Flow and Transparency

Overview

Kanban is an Agile framework focused on **continuous workflow, transparency, and adaptability**. Unlike Scrum or XP, Kanban does not rely on fixed-length iterations; if iterations exist, they are very short (sometimes called “daily sprints”).

Work items are visualized on a **Kanban board**, and tasks flow continuously according to team capacity. New items can be added at any time, making Kanban highly flexible to changing priorities. Client communication is ongoing; stakeholders can monitor progress in real-time, and daily team meetings help coordinate work effectively.

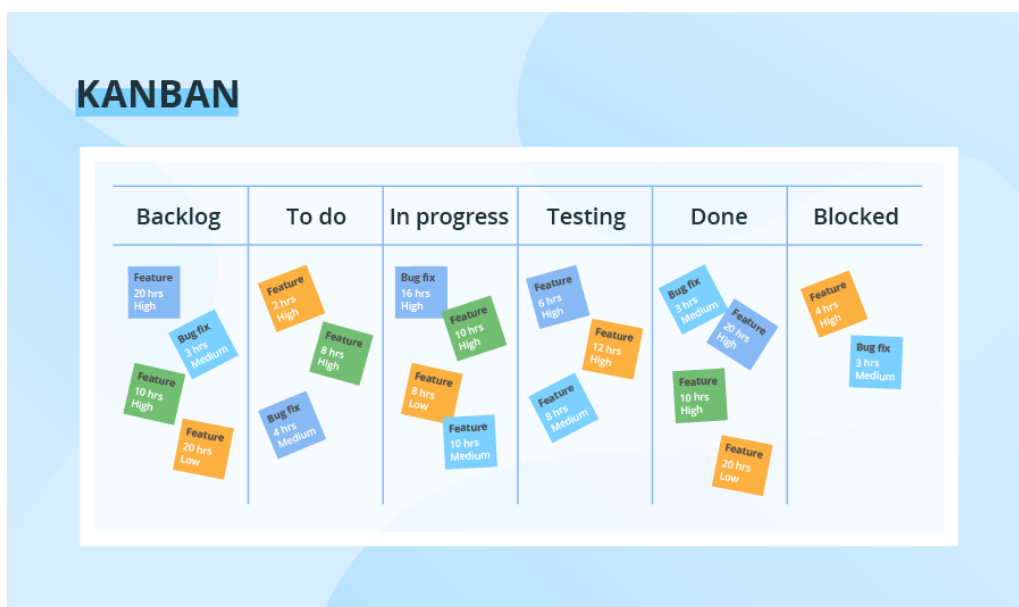


Figure 1: Kanban Board: Visualizing Tasks in Continuous Flow

Core Principles

- **Continuous Flow:** Tasks move smoothly through the workflow from start to finish.
- **Transparency:** Work is visible to all stakeholders, enabling better prioritization.
- **Work-in-Progress (WIP) Limits:** Restricting WIP improves focus and prevents bottlenecks.
- **Adaptability:** New tasks can be added dynamically as capacity allows.
- **Ongoing Communication:** Daily coordination and client access ensure alignment.

Benefits vs. Challenges

Benefits	Challenges
Enables quick delivery with minimal planning overhead.	Requires strong leadership to avoid miscoordination.
Visualizes the entire workflow, improving task prioritization.	WIP limits must be carefully set and enforced.
Allows tasks to be reprioritized or reshuffled dynamically.	Risk of moving in wrong direction or delivering misaligned outcomes.
Promotes transparency and accountability across the team.	Minimal rules and ceremonies can reduce structure if not monitored.

Best For

- Support, maintenance, and evolution projects with unpredictable task arrivals (e.g., bug fixes, small updates).
- Teams requiring high adaptability and visibility of ongoing work.

Not Ideal For

- New development projects with highly interdependent features requiring sequential delivery.
- Teams lacking mature self-management and development discipline.

Key Insight

Kanban emphasizes *continuous delivery*, *visual workflow*, and *adaptability*, enabling teams to respond quickly to changing priorities while maintaining transparency and focus on critical tasks.